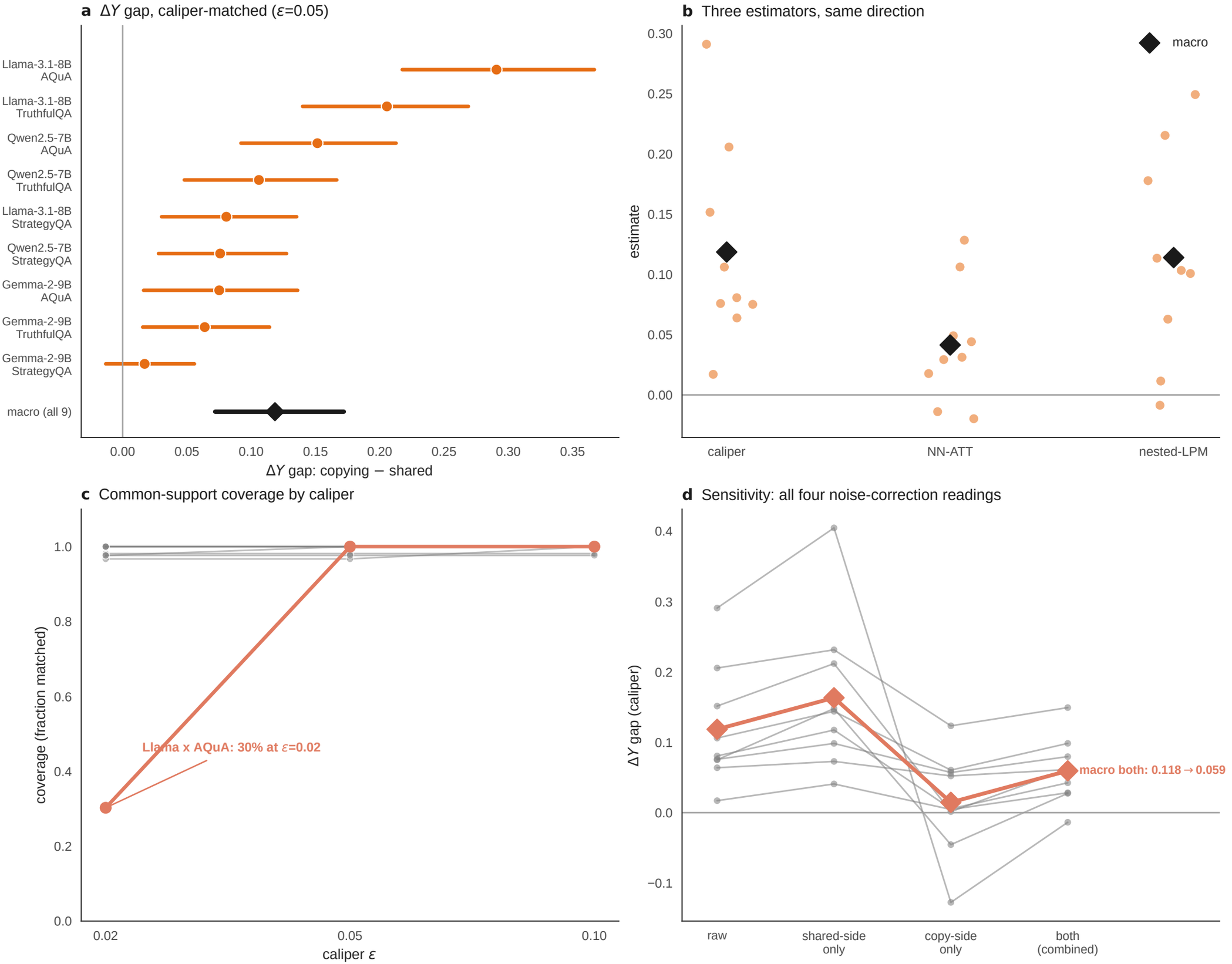Matched-dependence mechanism gap